Chapter 15 | Society, Law, Ethics & Cyber

15.1 Netiquette and Digital Citizenship

Netiquette: the accepted norms of polite online behaviour — **internet etiquette is commonly referred to as NETIQUETTE** (network + etiquette; the asked term against 'digital conduct', 'cyber ethics' and 'web manners').

(1) **Good netiquette in a forum**: **using proper grammar and punctuation** (the 2025 answer); before posting a comment, **ensure it is RESPECTFUL and RELEVANT**. The wrong-behaviour options — insults, personal attacks, spam, ignoring thread rules, sharing others' personal information, spreading misleading content — are all netiquette violations.

(2) **Privacy**: the privacy concern with Instant Messaging applications is **DATA SECURITY** — whether messages and personal data are protected from interception (free calls and a nice interface are features, not concerns). On social media, the correct 2024 statement: **children's sharing on social media must be monitored at all times** — the other options wrongly DENIED real risks (social-media addiction does hamper studies; rumours and fake news can put administration and law-and-order at risk).

Exam Points — 15.1

✦ Internet etiquette = netiquette; good practice = proper grammar/punctuation + respectful and relevant comments; IM privacy concern = data security; children's social-media sharing must be monitored (the only true statement).

15.2 Cyber Crime and Malicious Software

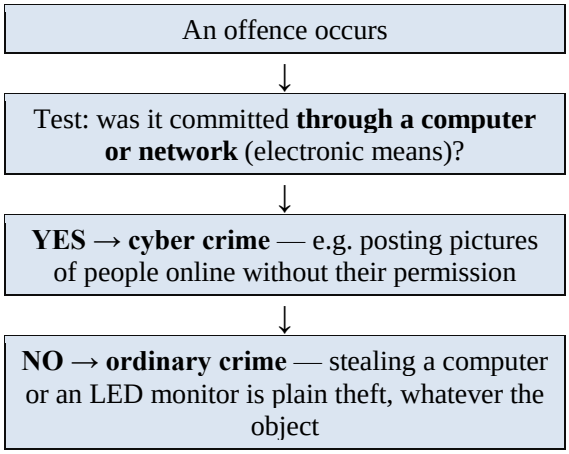


Fig. 15.1 — The cyber-crime test (NVS 2022): the means, not the object, decides.

(1) **Hacking = the act of gaining ILLEGAL ENTRY to computer files through remote terminals or microcomputers** — unauthorised access is an offence under the IT Act whether or not damage follows. Accessing your OWN bank account online is, of course, no crime.

(2) **Malware vocabulary**: **Perverse software is another name for MALICIOUS software** (malware). A **WORM does not perform any destructive action directly — it only consumes system resources**, self-replicating across the network without a host (a virus needs a host program; a trojan disguises itself). The full attack-and-malware toolkit — spoofing, DoS, honeypots, virus behaviour — is covered in Chapter 10, Section 10.12.

Exam Points — 15.2

✦ Cybercrime = offence via electronic means (unauthorised picture-posting yes; monitor theft no); hacking = illegal entry through remote terminals; perverse software = malicious software; worm = consumes resources, no direct destruction.

15.3 Cyber Law, the IT Act and Data Protection

(1) Remedies: in cyber security, **the law provides IMPRISONMENT** (and fines) as its remedy — not an apology. Offences such as hacking and data theft carry these penalties under the IT Act 2000 framework.

(2) Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023: the correct definition — **'Child' means an individual who has NOT completed the age of EIGHTEEN years**. The distractors misstated the Act: digital personal data is data in DIGITAL form (not physical); 'Chairperson' does mean the chairperson of the Board; and 'data' covers representations of facts, opinions and more — not facts only.

(3) E-commerce models (stray from the law band): the model that **specialises in selling products or services online is ONLINE DIRECT MARKETING** — producer to consumer through its own website, no intermediary; brick-and-mortar means a physical shop.

Exam Points — 15.3

✦ Cyber-law remedy = imprisonment; DPDP Act 2023: child = under 18 (digital data is digital, not physical); online direct marketing = selling online without a middleman.

15.4 Intellectual Property Rights

IPR: Intellectual Property Right — what enables the creator or owner to earn RECOGNITION or FINANCIAL BENEFIT from their creation or invention (the WIPO umbrella definition). The rights are **given to the CREATOR / INVENTOR** and are granted **for a CERTAIN (fixed) PERIOD of time**, after which the work enters the public domain.

Right	Protects	Note
Patent	Inventions	Fixed term (20 years typically)
Copyright	Creative works — books, software, music	Protects works, NOT inventions — why 'copyright' was too narrow for the umbrella question
Trademark	Brand names, logos	Renewable identity protection

Note: In the 2024 umbrella question the printed source key marked (b) copyright; the book's explanation corrects it to **(c) Intellectual property right**, since the wording covers both creations AND inventions — copyright alone cannot. The consolidated key carries (c).

Exam Points — 15.4

✦ IPR = recognition/financial benefit from creation or invention (the umbrella term — corrected key c); granted to the creator/inventor; for a certain period of time.

15.5 E-Waste Management

E-waste: irreparable computers and other electronic goods are known as ELECTRONIC WASTE in the tech world.

(1) Over half of the developed world's e-waste is exported to developing countries, mainly to INDIA, where metals like copper, iron, silicon, nickel and gold are recovered during recycling.

(2) E-Waste (Management) Rules 2016 recognise two broad categories — IT and telecommunication equipment, and consumer electricals/electronics — **including BOTH fluorescent and mercury-containing material (I and II)**.

(3) Exposure variability in e-waste handling comes from the **TYPE of e-waste** — different devices carry different hazardous materials, so risk varies by device type.

Exam Points — 15.5

✦ Irreparable electronics = e-waste; exported mainly to India (Cu/Fe/Si/Ni/Au recovered); Rules 2016 include fluorescent + mercury (both); exposure variability comes from the type of e-waste.

Quick Revision — Chapter 15 (12 Points)

1. Internet etiquette = NETIQUETTE; good conduct = proper grammar and punctuation, respectful and relevant comments.
2. IM privacy concern = data security; children's sharing on social media must be monitored at all times (the only correct statement).
3. Cyber crime test: committed through a computer/network → cyber crime (posting pictures without permission); physical theft of hardware = ordinary crime.
4. Hacking = gaining illegal entry to computer files through remote terminals or microcomputers; an IT Act offence even without damage.
5. Perverse software = malicious software (malware).
6. A worm consumes system resources without direct destruction — self-replicates over the network; virus needs a host, trojan disguises itself.
7. Cyber law's remedy = imprisonment (and fines), not apology.
8. DPDP Act 2023: 'child' = individual who has not completed eighteen years; digital personal data = data in digital form.
9. Online direct marketing = the e-commerce model selling products/services online, producer to consumer, no intermediary.
10. IPR = enables the creator/owner to earn recognition or financial benefit; granted to the creator/inventor for a CERTAIN period of time.
11. Patent protects inventions; copyright protects creative works; trademark protects brands — IPR is the umbrella over all of them.
12. E-waste = irreparable electronics; exported mainly to India; E-Waste Rules 2016 include fluorescent and mercury items (both); exposure varies by the TYPE of e-waste.